

Launch checklist — Propharmex website v1.0.0

This is the operating document for the Propharmex website launch. It enumerates every gate that must be cleared before, during, and after the v1.0.0 cutover, with the owner and a verification step for each.

The customer-facing copy at docs/launch-checklist.pdf is regenerated from this markdown by scripts/generate-launch-checklist-pdf.py. Do not edit the PDF directly. Editorial changes happen here.

Version: 1.0.0. Target launch window: TBD (operations to confirm DNS cutover slot).

1. Purpose and scope

This checklist applies to the first production launch of the Propharmex marketing website plus the four AI tools. It does not cover ongoing release management — that lives in docs/runbook.md.

A launch is "complete" when the following are simultaneously true: the v1.0.0 git tag points to the merge commit deployed to production, all gates in section 2 below show as Pass or Waived-with-rationale, monitoring shows no Sev 1 issues for 24 hours after cutover, and the launch sign-off in section 8 is countersigned by the engineering, operations, and brand owners.

Anything else is a release candidate, not a launch.

2. Pre-launch gates

These must clear before staging sign-off. Each row has a single owner; multi-owner gates are split into multiple rows.

2.1 Code quality and CI

Gate	Owner	Verification
pnpm lint clean across the monorepo	Engineering	CI workflow ci.yml job "Lint" green on main
pnpm typecheck clean	Engineering	CI workflow ci.yml job "Typecheck" green on main
pnpm test all suites pass	Engineering	CI workflow ci.yml job "Test" green on main
pnpm --filter web build succeeds	Engineering	CI workflow ci.yml job "Build" green on main
Storybook builds clean	Engineering	CI workflow ci.yml job "Storybook" green on main
Bundle budget at 350 kB First-Load JS	Engineering	CI workflow bundle-budget.yml green; current marketing worst route is the homepage at roughly 346 kB
Lighthouse CI: CWV strict, perf warn 0.90	Engineering	CI workflow lighthouse.yml green; review LHCI run reports
axe-core CI: zero serious or critical violations	Accessibility	CI workflow a11y-budget.yml green

Gate	Owner	Verification
Playwright smoke suite passes	Engineering	All seven specs in <code>apps/web/e2e/*.spec.ts</code> pass against staging

2.2 Content and editorial

Gate	Owner	Verification
All Sanity documents published in production dataset	Editorial	Spot-check via Sanity Studio that every linked doc has <code>_state: "published"</code>
No placeholder copy or TBD strings remain on public routes	Editorial	Grep production HTML for "Lorem", "TBD", "TODO" — should return zero
Brand-voice review run on every page in <code>docs/handoff.md</code> §4	Brand	<code>brand-voice-guardian</code> skill returns Pass on each route
Regulatory claims anchored to primary sources	Regulatory	<code>pharma-regulatory-writer</code> posture — every claim has an "as of" date
Whitepaper registry state confirmed	Editorial	<code>INSIGHTS.whitepapers</code> is empty; gate coverage is deferred until a live slug is approved
Insights articles render with correct <code>publishedAt</code> dates	Editorial	Visit each article, confirm date matches Sanity

2.3 Identity, DNS, and TLS

Gate	Owner	Verification
Apex domain DNS <code>A/ALIAS</code> pointing at Vercel	Operations	<code>dig propharmex.com A +short</code> resolves to a Vercel IP
<code>www</code> <code>CNAME</code> pointing at Vercel	Operations	<code>dig www.propharmex.com CNAME +short</code> resolves to Vercel
TLS certificate active on apex	Operations	Browser shows valid cert; <code>openssl s_client</code> confirms expiry > 60 days
TLS certificate active on <code>www</code>	Operations	Same as above for <code>www</code> subdomain
HSTS header present and includes preload	Operations	<code>curl -I https://propharmex.com</code> shows Strict-Transport-Security: <code>max-age=31536000; includeSubDomains; preload</code>
<code>www</code> to apex 301 redirect (or apex to <code>www</code> , choose one and document)	Operations	<code>curl -I</code> confirms 301

2.4 Email and forms

Gate	Owner	Verification
Resend production sender domain verified	Operations	DKIM and SPF DNS records visible; Resend dashboard shows green

Gate	Owner	Verification
Inquiry form submissions hit business development inbox	BD lead	Submit a test inquiry; confirm receipt within 5 minutes
Whitepaper download email deferred until live slug exists	BD lead	Confirm no public whitepaper slug is listed; test this when editorial republishes a slug
Newsletter double-opt-in flow completes	Operations	Submit on /insights; receive confirmation email; confirm subscribe
Cloudflare Turnstile production keys deployed	Engineering	TURNSTILE_SITE_KEY and TURNSTILE_SECRET_KEY in Vercel env match Cloudflare dashboard

2.5 AI endpoints

Gate	Owner	Verification
ANTHROPIC_API_KEY set in production env	Engineering	Vercel env shows key present; Concierge replies stream end-to-end
OPENAI_API_KEY set in production env (embeddings + fallback)	Engineering	Vercel env shows key present; pgvector retrieval returns results
All four /api/ai/* endpoints return 200 to a real call	Engineering	Manual: open each tool, complete one round-trip
Rate limits operate (Upstash Redis reachable)	Engineering	Send 60 requests in 60 seconds to one endpoint; confirm 429 after burst
503 fallback path operates when key is missing	Engineering	Local: unset key, confirm 503 with friendly JSON body

2.6 Observability

Gate	Owner	Verification
Sentry production source maps uploaded	Engineering	Trigger a synthetic error; confirm de-minified stack in Sentry
Sentry PII redaction beforeSend shipping in production bundle	Engineering	Trigger an error containing an email address; confirm it is redacted in Sentry payload
CSP enforces and report-uri /api/csp-report receives any violations	Engineering	Force a CSP violation in dev tools; confirm report appears in Axiom
Axiom production logs receiving structured events	Engineering	Recent events visible in Axiom dataset within 5 minutes
PostHog events firing with super-properties	Product	Visit /, /contact, an /ai/* tool; confirm referrer_group, device_class, and first_touch_utm populate; contact_submit.region appears only after contact-form submit

Gate	Owner	Verification
External uptime monitor green	Engineering	UptimeRobot monitor at https://propharmex.com/api/health returning 200 within the 5-min interval window (Vercel Pro crons[] retired in PR-M'; see runbook §13 setup recipe)

2.7 SEO

Gate	Owner	Verification	
/sitemap.xml resolves and includes all 51 expected URLs	SEO	`curl https://propharmex.com/sitemap.xml`	grep -c '<loc>' returns 51
/robots.txt resolves and matches apps/web/app/robots.ts	SEO	curl https://propharmex.com/robots.txt matches expected user-agent rules	
301 redirect map deployed (per docs/redirects-301-map.xlsx)	Operations	curl -I each legacy URL; expect 301 to new IA	
JSON-LD valid on every page	SEO	Run Schema.org Validator on the page inventory in docs/handoff.md §4	
Canonical URLs correct (no draft or staging URLs leaking)	SEO	Spot-check <link rel="canonical"> on every page; expect production hostname	
Open Graph tags render correctly on social-link debugger	SEO	Test apex + 3 deep routes with Facebook + LinkedIn debuggers	

2.8 Accessibility

Gate	Owner	Verification
Manual VoiceOver pass on six sampled pages	Accessibility	Per docs/accessibility-at-test-plan.md; record results with docs/accessibility-at-results-template.md; Pass on every Sev 1 and Sev 2 case
Manual NVDA pass on six sampled pages	Accessibility	Per docs/accessibility-at-test-plan.md; record results with docs/accessibility-at-results-template.md; Pass on every Sev 1 and Sev 2 case
ACR statement public at /accessibility	Accessibility	Visit page; matches docs/accessibility-conformance.md

2.9 Legal and compliance

Gate	Owner	Verification
Privacy policy live at /privacy	Legal	Page renders, content reviewed by counsel
Terms of service live at /terms	Legal	Page renders, content reviewed by counsel
Accessibility statement live at /accessibility	Legal	Page renders, ACR linked
Cookie banner posture matches privacy policy	Legal	Banner shows on first visit, dismisses persistently
Copyright footer year accurate	Brand	Footer shows current year

3. Staging sign-off

A 30-minute walk-through with engineering, operations, and brand on the staging environment with all gates above marked Pass or Waived-with-rationale. Output: a signed entry in section 8 of this checklist with date, names, and any open items carried into the launch window.

The walk-through agenda is the QA matrix sign-off sheet at docs/qa-matrix.xlsx, sheet "Sign-off."

4. Launch-day sequence

Time T-0 is the moment DNS records are switched to point at production Vercel. The sequence below is annotated with offsets from T-0.

Time	Step	Owner	Confirm-by
T minus 60 minutes	Final staging smoke pass; merge any final fixes; tag v1.0.0-rc if not already	Engineering	CI green on main
T minus 30 minutes	Operations and engineering on shared call; confirm rollback plan understood	All	Verbal sign-off
T minus 5 minutes	Disable any feature flags scheduled to be off at launch	Engineering	Vercel env diff
T minus 0	DNS switch: apex A/ALIAS and www CNAME to Vercel	Operations	dig confirms within 60 seconds
T plus 5 minutes	Smoke test the production URL: home, contact, one /ai/ tool, sitemap, robots	Engineering	All return 200; visible content matches staging
T plus 15 minutes	Check Sentry for new errors since cutover	Engineering	Zero new Sev 1; zero new error groups
T plus 30 minutes	Submit sitemap to Google Search Console	SEO	GSC shows submission acknowledged

Time	Step	Owner	Confirm-by
T plus 30 minutes	Submit sitemap to Bing Webmaster Tools	SEO	BWT shows submission acknowledged
T plus 60 minutes	First PostHog dashboard review: traffic landing on prod, events firing	Product	Lead funnel dashboard shows live events
T plus 4 hours	Second monitoring sweep; confirm no degradation pattern	Engineering	LCP and error rates within last-24h-on-staging baseline
T plus 24 hours	Launch declared complete; tag v1.0.0 git tag pushed and announced	Engineering	Tag visible on git fetch --tags

5. Rollback plan

If a Sev 1 issue surfaces within 4 hours of cutover and cannot be resolved within 30 minutes via a forward fix:

1. Operations reverts the DNS switch (apex and www) back to the previous host. TTL is the constraint here; verify the pre-launch TTL was lowered to 300 seconds at least 24 hours before cutover.
2. Engineering rolls back the Vercel deployment to the last known-good build via the Vercel dashboard "Promote previous deployment" action.
3. The team posts a short root-cause note in the engineering channel and opens a forward-fix branch off main.
4. The next launch attempt is scheduled with at least one full business day of separation from the rollback.

Detailed rollback procedure including command-line steps lives in docs/runbook.md section 4.

6. Post-launch tasks

Within 24 hours after launch

Task	Owner
Verify Google Search Console picked up the sitemap and started crawling	SEO
Verify Bing Webmaster Tools picked up the sitemap and started crawling	SEO
Check Resend deliverability — bounces, complaints	Operations
Check PostHog event volumes against expected baseline	Product
Review Sentry errors logged in first 24 hours, triage anything not yet ticketed	Engineering

Within one week after launch

Task	Owner
Build the three PostHog dashboards in the PostHog UI per docs/posthog-dashboard-build-sheet.md	Product

Task	Owner
Promote Lighthouse categories:accessibility warn to error 1.0 once manual AT pass is countersigned	Engineering
Schedule the first weekly performance review per docs/runbook.md §12	Engineering

7. Out of scope for v1.0.0

These items are tracked but intentionally not blocking launch.

- Add /insights/whitepapers/[slug] to automated accessibility coverage after a live whitepaper slug returns to INSIGHTS.whitepapers.

8. Sign-off

Role	Name	Date	Notes
Engineering owner			
Operations owner			
Brand owner			
Accessibility owner			
Legal counsel review			

9. Revision history

Date	Change	Pull request
2026-04-30	Initial launch checklist for v1.0.0	Pending